her.[1] The laboratory had constructed a model of the head using stone plaster after taking a mould from the human bomb Dhanu's severed head. It also identified Sivarasan and Subha by preparing models of their heads and then making a video comparison with their photographs. But that was that—they were often looking for that 'one more' clue, but it remained elusive. Chandrasekharan wanted to release this development to the media through a press conference, but the CBI got it scuttled in a clear message to him that it was not he who led the investigation.

Kanth examined surveillance reports from across India and overseas, particularly from Sri Lanka, the UK, France and the US, where there were many LTTE sympathizers. Besides, the SIT officers got 'unofficial' help from their batch mates posted in security agencies other than in the CBI.

Captain Ravindran was not into interrogation techniques that would take hours to secure a confession from the accused. Commandos were trained to swing into action in seconds and disarm the enemy in close-combat warfare. Therefore, he was not used to showing patience and sitting before an accused and questioning them endlessly. This was used as a tactic, as he, from time to time, would walk into different interrogation cells and play the 'bad cop'. It paid off.

Securing a confession from Nalini and Murugan still proved to be the toughest among all the suspects interrogated. They successfully adapted to the strategy of 'one step forward, two steps back'. Their 'passion for Tamil liberation' seemed to be winning over the team's interrogation tactics.

Both admitted they came close to each other within two weeks of Murugan's arrival. At that time, Nalini had walked out of her mother's house after a fight. Murugan had advised her to go back to her mother and brother but changed his mind, learning that Sivarasan was going to return with two girls (Dhanu and Shubha) from Jaffna, who might have to be put up with Nalini. This would not be possible if Nalini went to her mother's house. While falling in love with Nalini, Murugan admitted that he continued to apprise her of the 'sufferings of the Sri Lankan Tamils in the land of their birth and the atrocities committed by the IPKF' on them. Nalini started getting increasingly angry with Rajiv Gandhi. Murugan confessed